MAKING OF THE GLOBAL WORLD

1. **"The silk routes are a good example of vibrant pre-modern trade and cultural links."** Explain this statement with examples of goods and cultures that were exchanged.
2. How did the silk routes facilitate the exchange of religions and ideas across different continents? Provide specific examples from the text.
3. Describe the flow of trade between Asia and Europe through the silk routes. What did Asia export, and what did it receive in return from Europe?
4. **"Food offers many examples of long-distance cultural exchange."** Support this statement by tracing the origins and travels of common foods like noodles/spaghetti.
5. Explain how the introduction of the humble potato transformed the lives of the poor in Europe. What happened when this crop failed in Ireland?
6. Many of our common foods (potatoes, maize, tomatoes, chillies) were not known to our ancestors five centuries ago. How did these foods reach Asia and Europe?
7. How did the discovery of the Americas in the 16th century transform global trade and the lives of people in Europe and Asia?
8. **"The Portuguese and Spanish conquest of America was not just a result of conventional military weapons."** Identify the "most powerful weapon" used by the Europeans and explain why it was so effective against the native populations.
9. Why did the center of world trade shift from Asia (specifically China and India) to Europe starting from the 15th and 16th centuries? Mention the role of China's isolationist policy.
10. Describe the conditions in Europe until the 19th century that pushed people to migrate to the newly discovered Americas.